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General Comment

AI technology must respect creators and honor copyright laws to sustain innovation and fairness. When AI models train on protected works without consent, they exploit creators' intellectual property and undermine their ability to earn a living from their art and expertise. Ethical AI practices demand transparency, permission-based usage, and proper compensation (for future AND past theft of content), safeguarding both creativity and technological advancement. Protecting creators' rights is essential to building a fair, innovative digital future.

Google, OpenAI and the likes have gutted small American business through the theft of copyrighted materials. Creators must be protected and the current United States copyright laws must be enforced. Google Search and AI models have systematically harvested copyrighted materials from across the internet without creators' consent, reusing and repackaging original content for their own profit. This unauthorized scraping and regurgitation directly undermines creators, stripping them of web traffic, revenue, and recognition. Thousands of independent creator businesses—bloggers, photographers, artists, and writers—have collapsed because their original works, painstakingly developed through time and expertise, are now freely given out and monetized by big tech companies. To protect the integrity of creative labor, it's imperative to enforce stringent copyright protections and hold companies accountable, restoring creators' rights and preserving the foundation of digital entrepreneurship.